PRACTITIONER PROTOCOL

Chemical Relaxer

Follow your state board rules and the relaxer maker's instructions. Times are typical for a retouch.

SCREEN

Intake cleared. No cuts, sores, flare or infection on the scalp. No thio perm or curl on the hair.

STRAND TEST

Required for first visits, unknown history, color, or possible metallic dye. Record time and result.

PRE-CARE SENT

No shampoo, scratching or hard brushing for [48] hours. Arrive with hair detangled and dry.

SET UP FIRST

- ☐ Hands washed, gloves on
- ☐ Combs and clips cleaned and disinfected
- ☐ Relaxer brand, strength, lot recorded
- ☐ Protective base, neutralizing shampoo ready
- ☐ Fresh cape, towels, timer set
- ☐ Eyewash and SDS in reach

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Consult & screen**	10 min	Check scalp under good light. Assess texture, porosity, elasticity, history.
2	**Consent & photos**	5 min	Consent signed. Photos of new growth, hairline and nape.
3	**Choose relaxer**	5 min	Lye or no-lye, mild to super. Match strength to texture and scalp.
4	**Section & base**	10 min	Four quadrants on dry hair. Base entire scalp, hairline and ears.
5	**Protect old hair**	5 min	Conditioner or cream on previously relaxed lengths to prevent overlap.
6	**Apply relaxer**	6–10 min	New growth only, 1/4 inch off scalp. Resistant areas first, hairline last.
7	**Smooth**	Per maker	Smooth with gloved hands or comb back. Timer from first application.
8	**Rinse**	5 min	Lukewarm water, scalp to ends, until every trace of cream is gone.
9	**Neutralize**	5–10 min	Neutralizing shampoo, 2 to 3 times, until the color indicator runs clear.
10	**Condition & style**	20–40 min	Deep or protein-balancing conditioner. Heat protectant, moderate heat.
11	**Aftercare & rebook**	5 min	Scalp check. Review sheet and card. Book retouch at 8–10 weeks.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Smooth, even texture; never past maker max time
- Fine or color-treated hair: milder strength, no-lye
- Never relax over a thio perm or curl, or vice versa
- Leave a little texture: bone straight weakens hair

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Burning or stinging: rinse that area at once with cool water, then neutralize gently.
- Blistering, open skin or severe pain: stop, rinse 15–20 minutes, refer to a physician.
- Hives, swelling or trouble breathing: stop and rinse. Call 911.
- Relaxer in the eye: flush at the eyewash for 15 minutes; seek medical care.
- Hair turns gummy or stretches: rinse now, skip heat, protein treatment, reassess.
- Scabs or soreness reported later: no chemicals until fully healed.

Always write an incident report and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Lye / no-lye · strength	Brand · lot	New growth length	Processing time
Scalp before · after	Strand test result	Treatment · products	Next retouch · initials